



INDUSTRY NEWS

MAKE IN INDIA

Maharashtra hopes to be electronics hub by 2020

Maharashtra government is counting on the electronic system design and manufacturing (ESDM) policy for developing the state as an electronics hub, with an annual turnover of US\$ 12 billion by 2020. The policy plans to increase the ESDM sector's exports to US\$ 2 billion and create additional employment for 100,000 people by 2020.

The government has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with Vedanta group's Anil Agarwal-led Twinstar Display Technologies, promoted by Volcan Investments, to set up an LCD manufacturing unit, known as Panel FAB. Under the agreement, Twinstar Display Technologies will invest US\$ 10 billion over five phases.

The government will offer investors many incentives including industrial promotion subsidy. Additionally, all new and expansion units will be eligible for interest subsidy on term loans availed from banks and public financial institutions for acquisition of fixed assets for the eligible project.

The eligible new ESDM units will get a power tariff subsidy to the tune of one rupee per unit for a period of three years in category A and B areas and five years in other parts of the state.

New ESDM units will also be exempt from paying electricity duty for 15 years and from stamp duty during the investment period, for acquiring land and for term-loan purposes.

DeitY to launch EDF

The government's Department of Electronics and Information Technology (DeitY) has joined hands with Canbank Venture Capital Fund to launch Electronic Development Fund (EDF). This initiative is a way to devise a fund of funds to participate in daughter funds, which, in turn, will provide risk capital to companies developing new technologies in the area of electronics, nano-electronics and IT.

The idea of EDF was first proposed

by National Policy of Electronics in 2011, but did not generate much interest until Prime Minister Narendra Modi picked it up again and launched it during the inauguration of Digital India Week on July 1, 2015.

Sectors that fall in the periphery of EDF include start-ups, government and private-sector companies and institutions, micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs), larger established corporate and scientific and research or educational institutions.

National Action Plan for telecom sector

Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE) has signed an MoU with Department of Telecommunications (DoT) to develop and implement National Action Plan for skills development in the telecom sector by using public sector units (PSUs) under DoT. This unifies the

goal of fulfilling the requirements for skilled manpower in the telecom sector and providing quality options for employment/entrepreneurship.

MSDE and DoT will make a unified effort to mobilise financial assistance for different activities under National Ecosystem for the Develop-

On the Move

Samsung appoints Srinji Sundararajan as head of network business

Samsung Electronics Co. Ltd has appointed Srinji Sundararajan as head of network business at Samsung India Electronics Ltd. He will be in charge of managing operations and further developing business opportunities of Samsung's mobile network business in Southwest Asia.

Facebook India head Kirithiga Reddy steps down

Kirithiga Reddy, managing director for Facebook India, has quit the world's largest social networking firm due to personal reasons. She joined the Menlo Park, California-headquartered company in July 2011, and is credited to be the first Indian employee of the firm.

Exits at Apple India

Apple's long time India head Maneesh Dhir has resigned and the company is now looking for a new country manager. Dhir joined Apple in 2010 as country manager for India and under his reign, sales from the country grew from a mere US\$ 100 million to over US\$ 1 billion.

Sharad Mehrotra, Apple's enterprise mobility head in India, has quit and set up a handset company. Mehrotra, who was with Apple India since October 2007, has co-founded Hyve Mobility, which will launch Android based smartphones, the operating system that rivals Apple's iOS.

ment of Telecom Skills.

The partnership will also ensure that the two ministries make joint efforts to use old telephone exchanges of PSUs under DoT that are no longer in use, or exchanges that have become outdated for the telecom sector, for training purposes as well as to upgrade these exchanges, as per needs.